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TECHGRIT TALKS · LIVE WEBINAR · THURSDAY, OCTOBER 29, 2026

Cloud Migration in the AI Era: From Assumptions to Evidence

Agentic loops, rich context, and the new cost of modernization



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Founder & CEO, Tidal · Guest

HOW WE'LL SPEND THE NEXT 45 MINUTES

A conversation

OPEN

Intro

Why migrations stall, and what AI changed

FIRESIDE

From assumptions to evidence

What agentic loops change about the cost of modernization - and what they still can't do on their own

SHOW

Short demo

The same loop, with and without context

YOUR TURN

Live Q&A

Drop questions in the chat any time

We'll build a practical checklist together using your ideas from the chat.

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BEFORE WE BEGIN · A PRACTITIONER'S VIEW

Nearly 460 applications. Years of work.
The hardest part was never the code.

01

Who owns this app?

And who gets the call when it breaks

02

What does it talk to at 2 a.m.?

The batch jobs and feeds nobody documented

03

Can we turn it off?

Or does someone still depend on it

AIX to AWS, a multi year program starting in 2018. Every application had one or two people who knew the answers, and they were already busy.

? **How much of your portfolio lives in someone's head?**

THE MARKET · WHAT THE DATA SAYS

Three out of four cloud migrations ran over budget

75%

of cloud migrations ran over budget

38%

were delayed by more than a quarter

$100B+

of migration spend that did not deliver, over three years

Source: McKinsey, "Cloud-migration opportunity: Business value grows, but missteps abound," survey of about 450 CIOs and IT decision makers, 2020 to 2021.

? **Was the problem the cloud, or what we didn't know about our apps?**

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WHAT CHANGED · 2025 TO 2029

The code is getting cheap

WHERE A DEVELOPER'S WEEK GOES



- **Writing or improving code** what AI is speeding up
- **Everything else** maintaining, testing, securing, and working out what is already there

Source: Tidelift and The New Stack developer survey, 2019.

90% of software modernization done with AI augmented tools by 2029, up from under 15% in 2025

50% lower modernization labor cost by 2029, compared with 2025

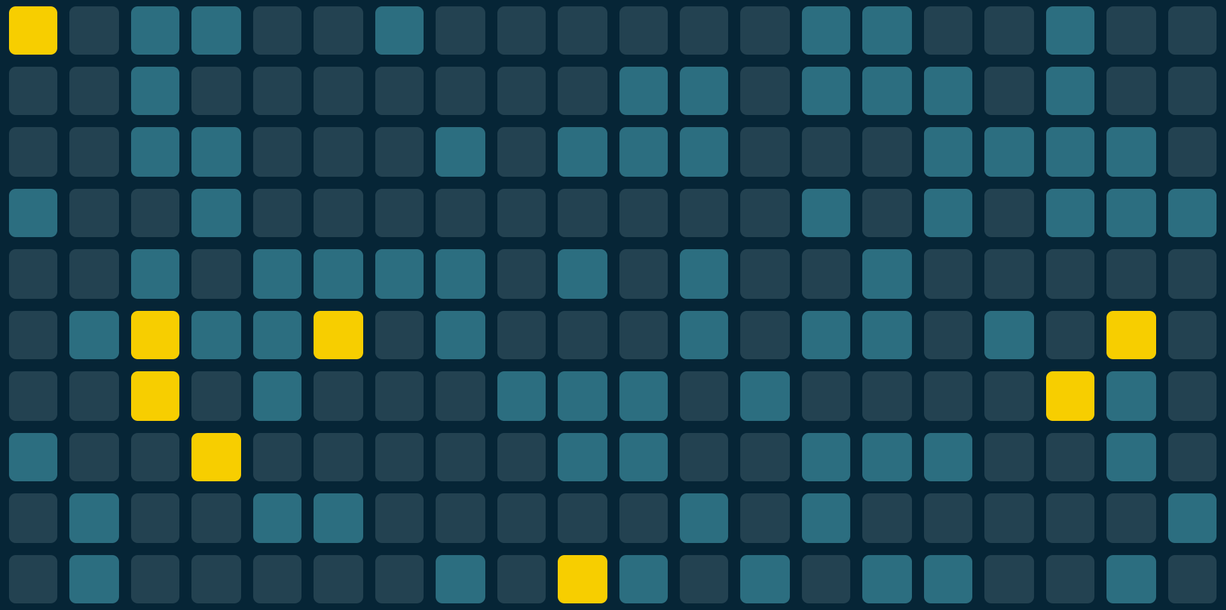
Gartner forecast, Innovation Insight for AI Augmented Code Modernization Tools, July 2025.

? If changing code becomes nearly free, what becomes the hard part?

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BEAT 1 · THE OLD ASSUMPTION

"Modernization is expensive. So we lift and shift it, or leave it alone."



Left alone

Lifted and shifted

Properly modernized

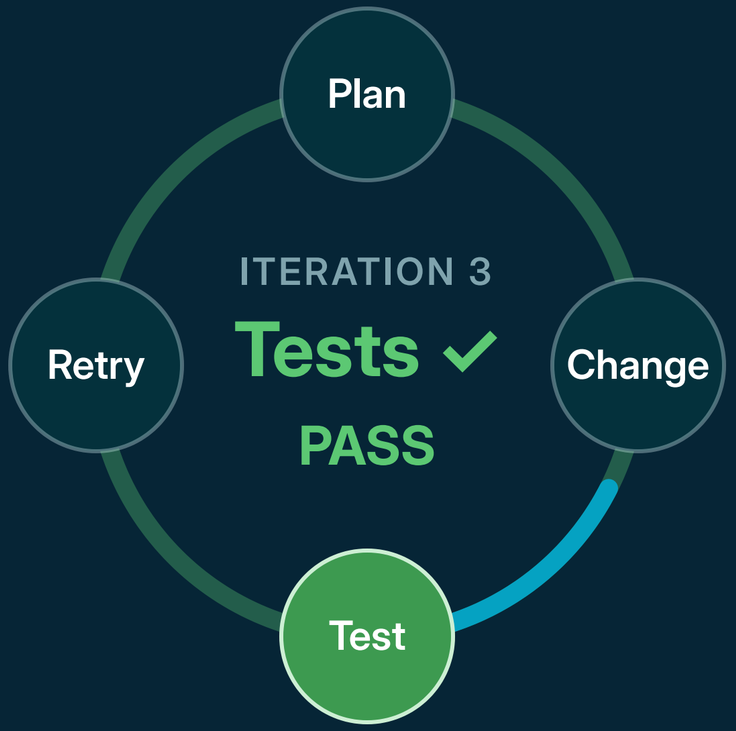
A typical-looking portfolio. Illustrative, not data.

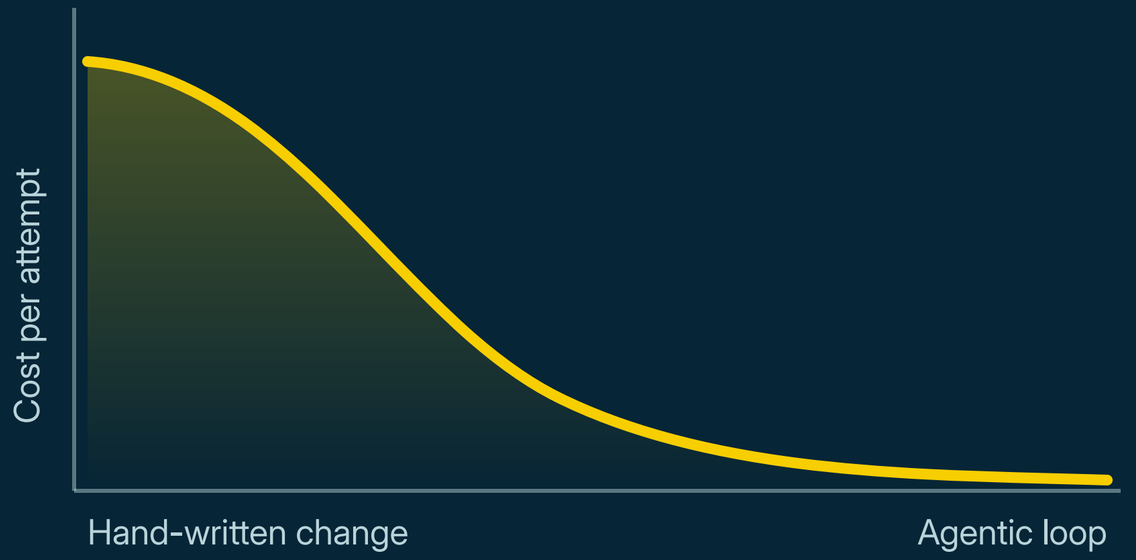
? What does it cost to modernize one app properly?

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BEAT 2 · BREAK THE MATH

An agent loop: plan, change, test, retry until it passes





Each retry costs minutes, not sprints. The cost of execution is trending toward zero.

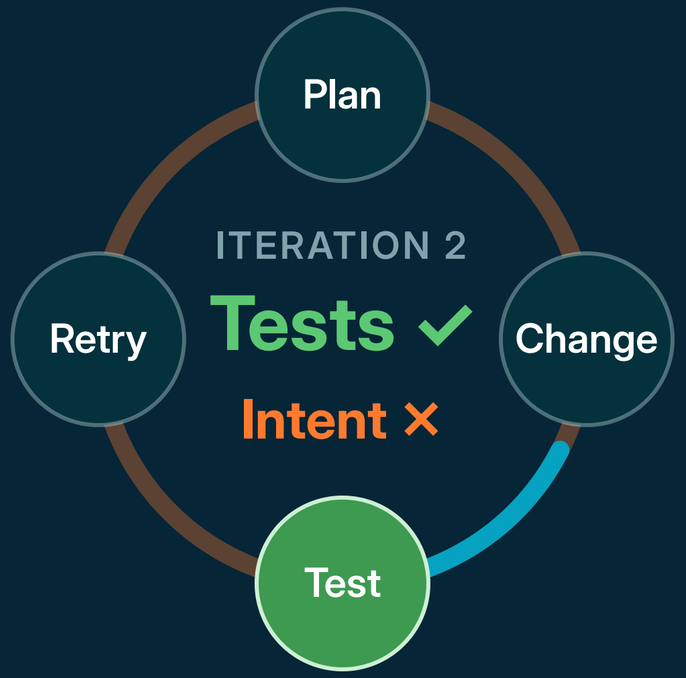
Illustrative trend, not measured data

? So... is every app affordable to modernize now?

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BEAT 3 · THE TWIST

Same loop. No context. Confidently wrong.



- ✕ Rebuilt a module the business already planned to retire
- ✕ Dropped a nightly partner file feed the repo never mentions
- ✕ Optimized what's easy to measure, not what the owner cares about

Illustrative failure patterns

> **"Correct in shape but wrong in business intent."**
>
> David Colebatch, "The Architecture Question That Never Dies", tidalcloud.com blog

? What does the agent need that the code doesn't contain?

BEAT 4 · YOUR TURN - USE THE CHAT

What does the agent need that the code doesn't contain?

1. **Business intent**
   Why does this app exist?
2. **Owners**
   Who decides, who gets paged?
3. **Dependencies**
   What breaks if it moves?
4. **Data flows**
   Who reads and writes its data?
5. **Risk & compliance**
   What can't go wrong?
6. **What matters to the business**
   Value, criticality, cost of downtime
7. **What can be retired**
   Not everything deserves a loop

BEAT 5 · THE BOTTLENECK

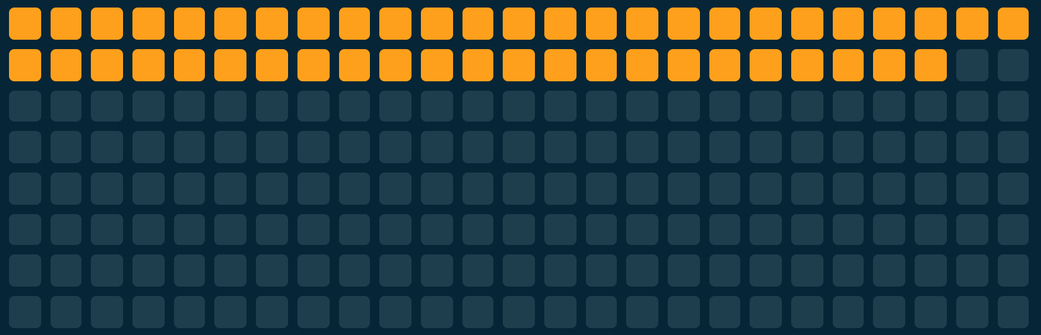
Now gather that list for 200 apps. By hand.

The change
agentic loop, per app



The context
interviews, workshops, spreadsheets





48 of 200 apps with context gathered · **Illustrative** portfolio, relative pace only

The scarce thing is no longer code. It's context.

"At enterprise scale, manual approaches break down because of duplicated evidence collection, inconsistent scoring, weak provenance, and the inability to maintain the assessment as evidence changes." - tidalcloud.com/enterprise-modernization

? **Where does rich context come from, at portfolio scale?**

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BEAT 6 · YOUR LIST, ANSWERED

Context gathered at portfolio speed

tidal accelerator

1. Business intent ✓
2. Owners ✓
3. Dependencies ✓
4. Data flows ✓
5. Risk & compliance ✓
6. What matters to the business ✓
7. What can be retired ✓

Server & infrastructure discovery
Apps, servers, databases and data pipelines, grouped by application
→ dependencies · data flows

Source code & database analysis
Languages, frameworks, data stores and their constraints
→ dependencies · risk

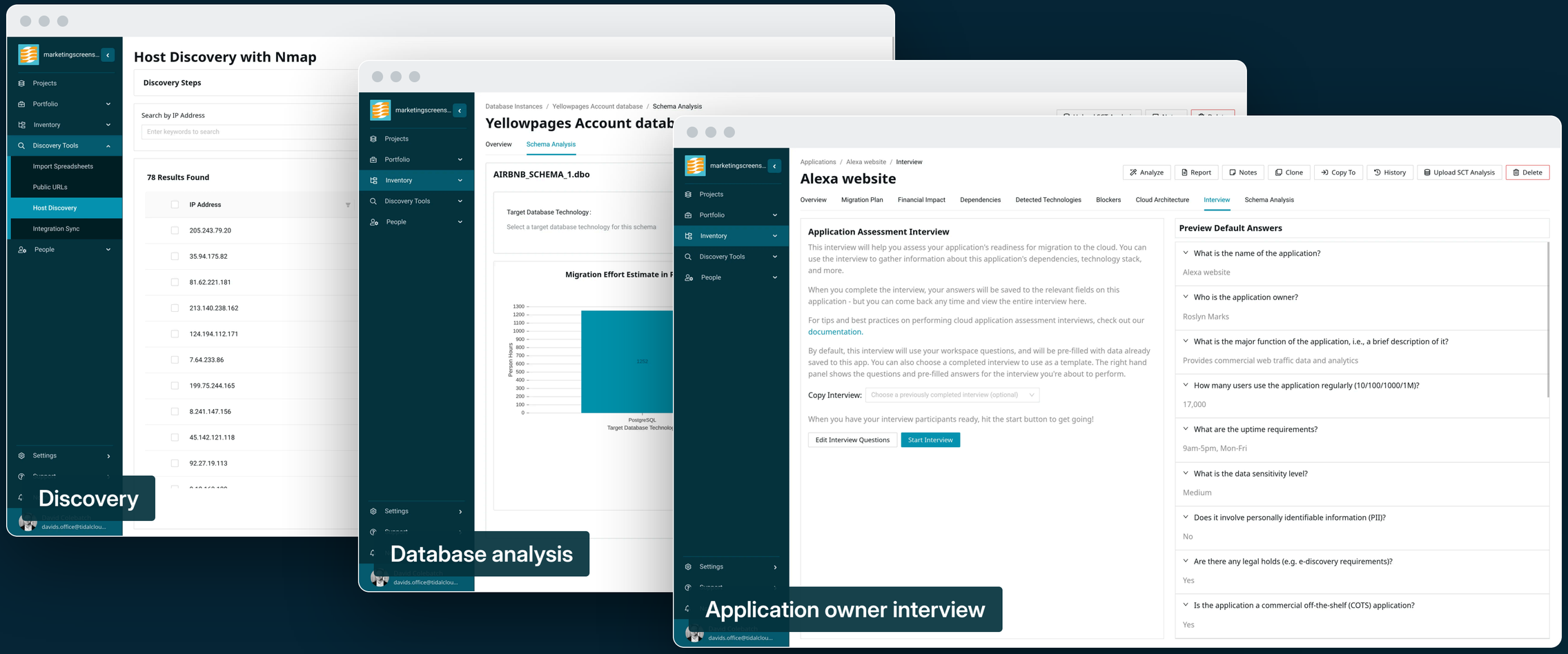
Business context capture
Application owner interviews: 20 ready-made, customizable questions
→ intent · owners · what matters · what can be retired · your additions

AI-assisted insights
Risk patterns and modernization candidates, grounded in evidence
→ risk · what can be retired

API, CLI and published agent skills
So your coding agents read the context before they loop

REAL CAPTURES · DEMO WORKSPACE

Evidence, not assumptions



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FROM RECORD TO LOOP

Context your coding agents can actually read

Accelerator
application record and evidence

→

API + Tidal Tools CLI
typed, auditable access

→

Agent skill
public, open standard

→

Your coding agent
plans with context, then loops

```
# Public: github.com/tidalmigrations/agent-skills
$ npx skills add tidalmigrations/agent-skills --skill tidal-tools
$ tidal login
$ tidal analyze code
```

Works with Agent Skills-compatible tools such as Cursor, Claude Code and Kiro, per the repository README.

> **"Guardrails live below the agent."**
>
> David Colebatch, "The Architecture Question That Never Dies", tidalcloud.com blog

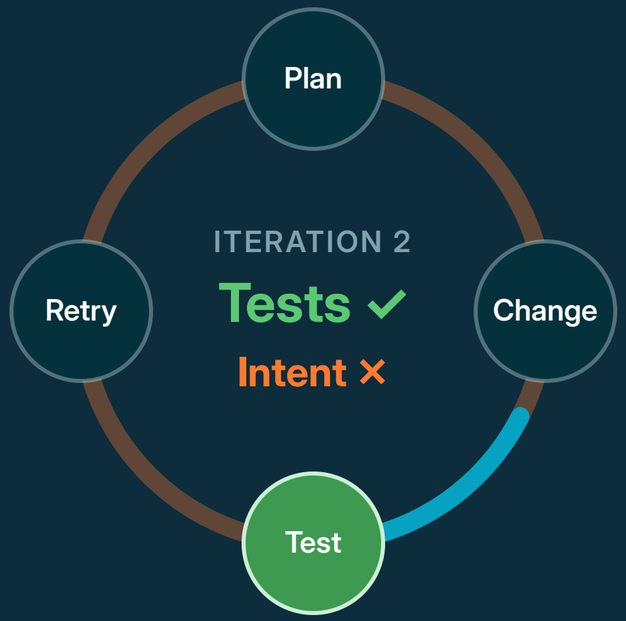
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DEMO

The same loop, with and without context

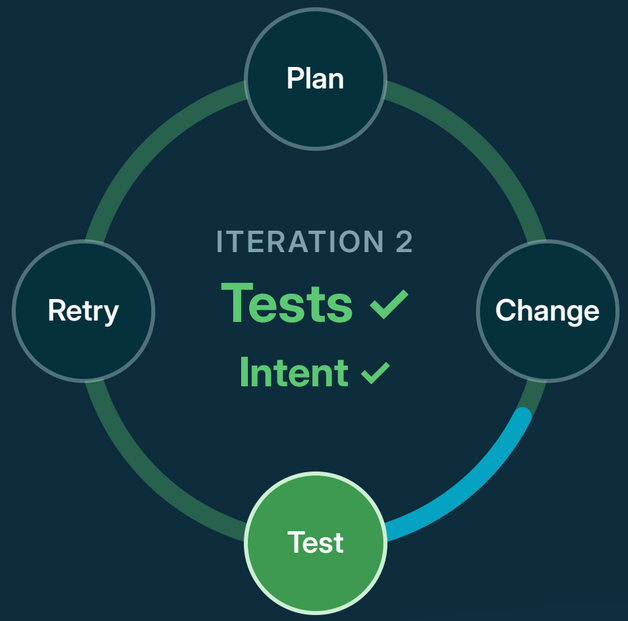
Raw code only

tests pass · intent missed



Code + portfolio context

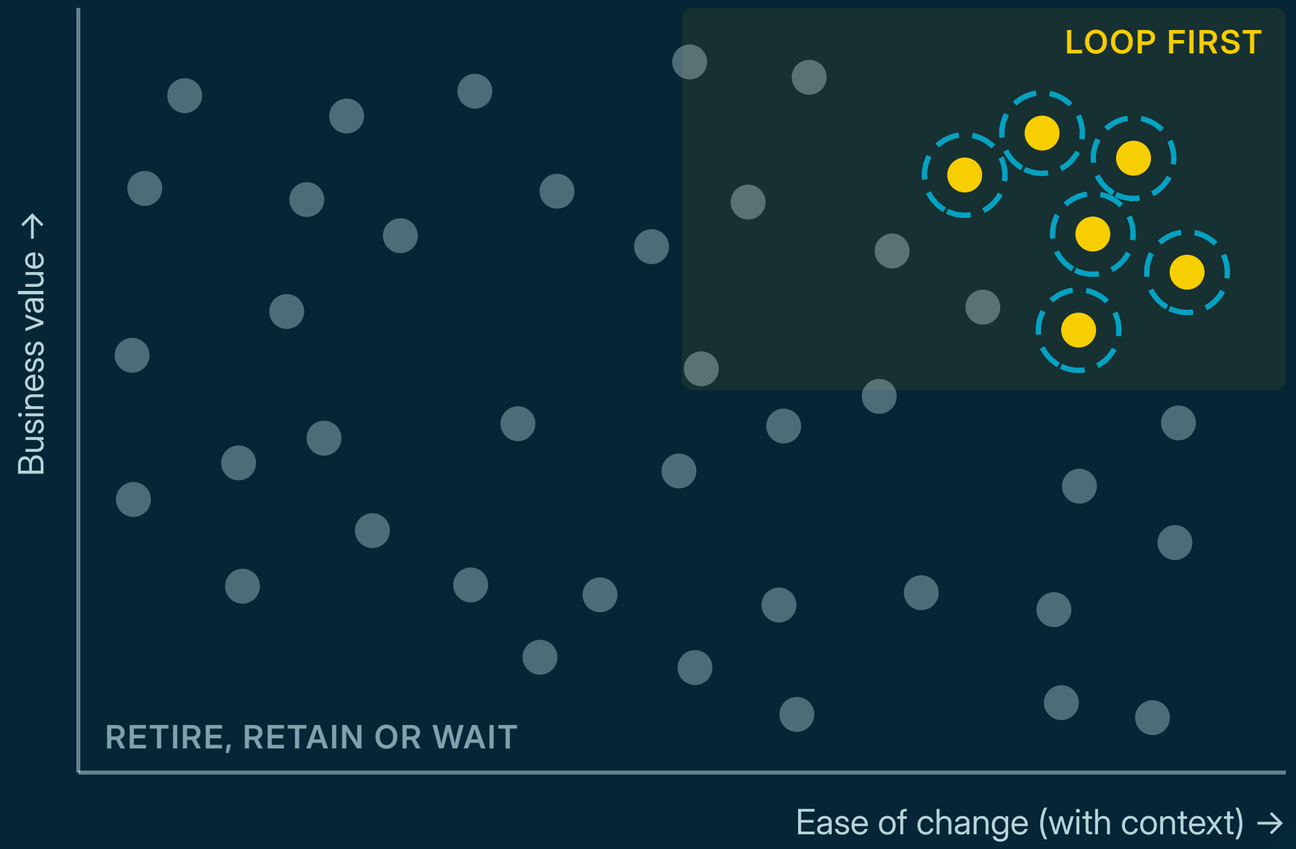
tests pass · intent met



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BEAT 7 · PORTFOLIO, NOT PRODUCT

With context, point the loops at the highest-value apps first



Context tells you which apps deserve a loop, which should be retired, and which can wait.

That's a portfolio decision - made before you spend on execution.

Illustrative portfolio

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FREE TO USE · THE EDUCATIONAL SPINE

Tidal Enterprise Modernization Methodology™

DISCOVER

Enterprise Intelligence

Evidence-backed context, not mere inventory

Portfolio discovery

Owner interviews, dependencies, code and data

DECIDE

Transformation Strategy

The right future for each app

Workload classification (6R)

Prioritization

Migration path definition

DELIVER

Measurable Business Outcomes

Not merely "apps moved"

Point loops at approved, high-value work

Return new evidence to the record



Reassess as conditions change - the methodology is a loop too.

tidalcloud.com/enterprise-modernization

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TECHGRIT × TIDAL · HOW WE WORK TOGETHER

Tidal brings the evidence. TechGrit turns it into production.

DISCOVER — Tidal Accelerator

Build the evidence

- Infrastructure and dependency discovery
- Code and database analysis
- Application owner interviews

DECIDE — Tidal + TechGrit

Set each app's path

- 6R disposition for every app
- Prioritized waves and roadmap
- Target architecture and path

DELIVER — TechGrit

Move and modernize

- Rehost, replatform, and refactor by wave
- AI accelerated engineering, read from the record
- Data migration, testing, and cutover
- Run, optimize, and feed evidence back

One record of evidence, from first scan to production. Every wave returns new evidence to it.

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ONE THING TO REMEMBER

The cost of modernization is now set by the quality of your context.

LIVE Q&A

Your questions

Use the chat. Jittu will bring them in.

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THANK YOU

Thank you for joining TechGrit Talks



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START HERE

Understand your portfolio first.

Tidal's modernization methodology is free to use.

tidalcloud.com/enterprise-modernization

WHEN YOU'RE READY

Turn the evidence into production.

TechGrit and Tidal, from portfolio discovery to delivery.

techgrit.com/what-we-do/ai-modernization

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